

# The Exponent Rules

## Exponent Rules Learned in Pre-Algebra

I)  $x^a \cdot x^b = x^{a+b}$  Example:  $x^2 \cdot x^5 = x^{2+5} = x^7$

II)  $\frac{x^a}{x^b} = x^{a-b}$ ,  $x \neq 0$  Example:  $\frac{x^9}{x^3} = x^{9-3} = x^6$

## New Exponent Rules

III)  $(xy)^a = x^a \cdot y^a$  Example:  $(2m)^4 = 2^4 \cdot m^4$

IV)  $\left(\frac{x}{y}\right)^a = \frac{x^a}{y^a}$ ,  $y \neq 0$  Example:  $\left(\frac{n}{3}\right)^7 = \frac{n^7}{3^7}$

V)  $(x^a)^b = x^{ab}$  Example:  $(x^{10})^3 = x^{10 \cdot 3} = x^{30}$

## Strange New Exponent Rules

VI)  $x^1 = x$  Example:  $3^1 = 3$

VII)  $x^0 = 1$ ,  $x \neq 0$  Example:  $5^0 = 1$

VIII)  $x^{-a} = \frac{1}{x^a}$ ,  $x \neq 0$  Example:  $x^{-2} = \frac{1}{x^2}$

IX)  $x^{\frac{1}{a}} = \sqrt[a]{x}$  Example:  $x^{\frac{1}{3}} = \sqrt[3]{x}$

X)  $x^{\frac{b}{a}} = (\sqrt[a]{x})^b$  or  $\sqrt[a]{x^b}$  Example:  $x^{\frac{5}{7}} = (\sqrt[7]{x})^5$  or  $\sqrt[7]{x^5}$



Using the Chain Rule with the Product Rule or the Quotient Rule

### Differentiation Formulas

Constant Rule i)  $\frac{d}{dx}(c) = 0$  "c" is a constant.

Power Rule ii)  $\frac{d}{dx}(x^n) = nx^{n-1}$  "n" is a constant.

Constant Multiple Rule iii)  $\frac{d}{dx}[cf(x)] = cf'(x)$  "c" is a constant.

Sum Rule iv)  $\frac{d}{dx}[f(x) + g(x)] = f'(x) + g'(x)$

Difference Rule v)  $\frac{d}{dx}[f(x) - g(x)] = f'(x) - g'(x)$

Product Rule vi)  $\frac{d}{dx}[f(x)g(x)] = f'(x)g(x) + f(x)g'(x)$

Quotient Rule vii)  $\frac{d}{dx}\left[\frac{f(x)}{g(x)}\right] = \frac{f'(x)g(x) - f(x)g'(x)}{[g(x)]^2}$

The Chain Rule viii) If  $h(x) = f(g(x))$ , then

$$h'(x) = f'(g(x))g'(x)$$

### Three Steps For the Chain Rule

- 1) Find the derivative of the outside function while
- 2) leaving the inside function unchanged.
- 3) Multiply the resulting expression by the derivative of the inside function.

### Trigonometric Differentiation Formulas

$$I) \frac{d}{dx}(\sin x) = \cos x$$

$$II) \frac{d}{dx}(\cos x) = -\sin x$$

$$III) \frac{d}{dx}(\csc x) = -\csc x \cot x$$

$$IV) \frac{d}{dx}(\sec x) = \sec x \tan x$$

$$V) \frac{d}{dx}(\tan x) = \sec^2 x$$

$$VI) \frac{d}{dx}(\cot x) = -\csc^2 x$$



Using the Chain Rule with the Product Rule

Find  $f'(x)$ .

• ①  $f(x) = x^3 \cos(5x^4)$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx}(x^3) \right] \cos(5x^4) + x^3 \frac{d}{dx}(\cos(5x^4))$$

$$= 3x^2 \cos(5x^4) + x^3 \left[ -\sin(5x^4) \right] \frac{d}{dx}(5x^4)$$

$$= 3x^2 \cos(5x^4) - x^3 \left[ \sin(5x^4) \right] 20x^3$$

$$= \boxed{3x^2 \cos(5x^4) - 20x^6 \sin(5x^4)}$$

②  $f(x) = (3x^2+2)^4 x^2$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx}((3x^2+2)^4) \right] x^2 + (3x^2+2)^4 \frac{d}{dx}(x^2)$$

$$= 4(3x^2+2)^{4-1} \left[ \frac{d}{dx}(3x^2+2) \right] x^2 + (3x^2+2)^4 (2x)$$

$$= 4(3x^2+2)^3 (6x) x^2 + 2x(3x^2+2)^4$$

$$= \boxed{24x^3(3x^2+2)^3 + 2x(3x^2+2)^4}$$

③  $f(x) = x^4 \sqrt[3]{2+4x^2+x^3}$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx}(x^4) \right] \sqrt[3]{2+4x^2+x^3} + x^4 \frac{d}{dx}(\sqrt[3]{2+4x^2+x^3})$$

$$f'(x) = 4x^3 \sqrt[3]{2+4x^2+x^3} + x^4 \frac{d}{dx}((2+4x^2+x^3)^{\frac{1}{3}})$$

$$f'(x) = 4x^3 \sqrt[3]{2+4x^2+x^3} + x^4 \frac{1}{3}(2+4x^2+x^3)^{\frac{1}{3}-1} \frac{d}{dx}(2+4x^2+x^3)$$

$$f'(x) = 4x^3 \sqrt[3]{2+4x^2+x^3} + \frac{1}{3}x^4 (2+4x^2+x^3)^{-\frac{2}{3}} (8x+3x^2)$$

$$f'(x) = 4x^3 \sqrt[3]{2+4x^2+x^3} + \frac{1}{3}x^4 \frac{1}{\sqrt[3]{(2+4x^2+x^3)^2}} (8x+3x^2)$$

$$f'(x) = \boxed{4x^3 \sqrt[3]{2+4x^2+x^3} + \frac{8x^5+3x^6}{3\sqrt[3]{(2+4x^2+x^3)^2}}}$$



④  $f(x) = x^5 \sin(-2x^2)$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx}(x^5) \right] \sin(-2x^2) + x^5 \frac{d}{dx}(\sin(-2x^2))$$

$$f'(x) = 5x^4 \sin(-2x^2) + x^5 [\cos(-2x^2)] \frac{d}{dx}(-2x^2)$$

$$f'(x) = 5x^4 \sin(-2x^2) + x^5 [\cos(-2x^2)](-4x)$$

$$f'(x) = \boxed{5x^4 \sin(-2x^2) - 4x^6 \cos(-2x^2)}$$

⑤  $f(x) = (x^3 + 7x^2 + x - 8)^3 x^6$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx}((x^3 + 7x^2 + x - 8)^3) \right] x^6 + (x^3 + 7x^2 + x - 8)^3 \frac{d}{dx}(x^6)$$

$$f'(x) = \left[ 3(x^3 + 7x^2 + x - 8)^{2-1} \frac{d}{dx}(x^3 + 7x^2 + x - 8) \right] x^6 + (x^3 + 7x^2 + x - 8)^3 6x^5$$

$$f'(x) = \boxed{3x^6 (x^3 + 7x^2 + x - 8)^2 (3x^2 + 14x + 1) + 6x^5 (x^3 + 7x^2 + x - 8)^3}$$

⑥  $f(x) = x^7 \sqrt[4]{10x-7}$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx}(x^7) \right] \sqrt[4]{10x-7} + x^7 \frac{d}{dx}(\sqrt[4]{10x-7})$$

$$f'(x) = 7x^6 \sqrt[4]{10x-7} + x^7 \frac{d}{dx}[(10x-7)^{\frac{1}{4}}]$$

$$f'(x) = 7x^6 \sqrt[4]{10x-7} + x^7 \left[ \frac{1}{4} (10x-7)^{\frac{1}{4}-1} \frac{d}{dx}(10x-7) \right]$$

$$f'(x) = 7x^6 \sqrt[4]{10x-7} + \frac{1}{4} x^7 (10x-7)^{-\frac{3}{4}} (10)$$

$$f'(x) = \boxed{7x^6 \sqrt[4]{10x-7} + \frac{5x^7}{2 \sqrt[4]{(10x-7)^3}}}$$



## Using the Chain Rule Twice

Differentiate.

• ⑦  $f(x) = (-x+1)^5 \tan \sqrt{x}$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx} (-x+1)^5 \right] \tan \sqrt{x} + (-x+1)^5 \frac{d}{dx} (\tan \sqrt{x})$$

$$f'(x) = \left[ 5(-x+1)^{5-1} \frac{d}{dx} (-x+1) \right] \tan \sqrt{x} + (-x+1)^5 \frac{d}{dx} (\tan(x^{\frac{1}{2}}))$$

$$f'(x) = 5(-x+1)^4 (-1) \tan \sqrt{x} + (-x+1)^5 \sec^2(x^{\frac{1}{2}}) \frac{d}{dx} (x^{\frac{1}{2}})$$

$$f'(x) = -5(-x+1)^4 \tan \sqrt{x} + (-x+1)^5 \sec^2(\sqrt{x}) \frac{1}{2} x^{\frac{1}{2}-1}$$

$$f'(x) = \boxed{-5(-x+1)^4 \tan \sqrt{x} + \frac{(-x+1)^5 \sec^2 \sqrt{x}}{2 \sqrt{x}}}$$

• ⑧  $f(x) = (8-2x+x^8)^2 \cot(x^9-2x)$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx} (8-2x+x^8)^2 \right] \cot(x^9-2x) + (8-2x+x^8)^2 \frac{d}{dx} (\cot(x^9-2x))$$

$$f'(x) = \left[ 2(8-2x+x^8)^{2-1} \frac{d}{dx} (8-2x+x^8) \right] \cot(x^9-2x) + (8-2x+x^8)^2 (-\csc^2(x^9-2x)) \frac{d}{dx} (x^9-2x)$$

$$f'(x) = 2(8-2x+x^8)(-2+8x^7) \cot(x^9-2x) - (8-2x+x^8)^2 [\csc^2(x^9-2x)] (9x^8-2)$$

$$f'(x) = \boxed{2(8-2x+x^8)(-2+8x^7) \cot(x^9-2x) - (8-2x+x^8)^2 (9x^8-2) \csc^2(x^9-2x)}$$

• ⑨  $f(x) = (3x-1)^3 \sec(x^2)$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx} (3x-1)^3 \right] \sec(x^2) + (3x-1)^3 \frac{d}{dx} (\sec(x^2))$$

$$f'(x) = \left[ 3(3x-1)^{3-1} \frac{d}{dx} (3x-1) \right] \sec(x^2) + (3x-1)^3 \sec(x^2) \tan(x^2) \frac{d}{dx} (x^2)$$

$$f'(x) = 3(3x-1)^2 (3) \sec(x^2) + (3x-1)^3 \sec(x^2) [\tan(x^2)] 2x$$

$$f'(x) = \boxed{9(3x-1)^2 \sec(x^2) + 2x(3x-1)^3 \sec(x^2) \tan(x^2)}$$



• ⑩  $f(x) = \sqrt{x^2-9} \csc(x^3)$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx} (\sqrt{x^2-9}) \right] \csc(x^3) + \sqrt{x^2-9} \frac{d}{dx} (\csc(x^3))$$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{d}{dx} (x^2-9)^{\frac{1}{2}} \right] \csc(x^3) + \sqrt{x^2-9} (-\csc(x^3) \cot(x^3) \frac{d}{dx} (x^3))$$

$$f'(x) = \left[ \frac{1}{2} (x^2-9)^{\frac{1}{2}-1} \frac{d}{dx} (x^2-9) \right] \csc(x^3) - \sqrt{x^2-9} \csc(x^3) [\cot(x^3)] 3x^2$$

$$f'(x) = \frac{1}{2} (x^2-9)^{-\frac{1}{2}} (2x) \csc(x^3) - 3x^2 \sqrt{x^2-9} \csc(x^3) \cot(x^3)$$

$$f'(x) = \frac{1}{2} \frac{1}{(x^2-9)^{\frac{1}{2}}} (2x) \csc(x^3) - 3x^2 \sqrt{x^2-9} \csc(x^3) \cot(x^3)$$

$$= \frac{2x \csc(x^3)}{2\sqrt{x^2-9}} - 3x^2 \sqrt{x^2-9} \csc(x^3) \cot(x^3)$$

$$= \boxed{\frac{x \csc(x^3)}{\sqrt{x^2-9}} - 3x^2 \sqrt{x^2-9} \csc(x^3) \cot(x^3)}$$

Using the Chain Rule with the Quotient Rule  
Find  $\frac{dy}{dx}$ .

• ⑪  $y = \frac{x}{\sin(6x^5)}$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\left[ \frac{d}{dx} (x) \right] \sin(6x^5) - x \frac{d}{dx} (\sin(6x^5))}{(\sin(6x^5))^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{(1) \sin(6x^5) - x \cos(6x^5) \frac{d}{dx} (6x^5)}{\sin^2(6x^5)}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\sin(6x^5) - x [\cos(6x^5)] (30x^4)}{\sin^2(6x^5)}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \boxed{\frac{\sin(6x^5) - 30x^5 \cos(6x^5)}{\sin^2(6x^5)}}$$



$$\textcircled{12} y = \frac{(3x+5)^3}{x^4+10}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\left[ \frac{d}{dx}((3x+5)^3) \right] (x^4+10) - (3x+5)^3 \frac{d}{dx}(x^4+10)}{(x^4+10)^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\left[ 3(3x+5)^{3-1} \frac{d}{dx}(3x+5) \right] (x^4+10) - (3x+5)^3 (4x^3)}{(x^4+10)^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{3(3x+5)^2 (3) (x^4+10) - 4x^3 (3x+5)^3}{(x^4+10)^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{9(3x+5)^2 (x^4+10) - 4x^3 (3x+5)^3}{(x^4+10)^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{(3x+5)^2 [9(x^4+10) - 4x^3(3x+5)]}{(x^4+10)^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{(3x+5)^2 (3x^4 + 20x^3 - 90)}{(x^4+10)^2}$$

$$\bullet \textcircled{13} y = \frac{\cos(x^2-1)}{4x+7}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\left[ \frac{d}{dx}(\cos(x^2-1)) \right] (4x+7) - \cos(x^2-1) \frac{d}{dx}(4x+7)}{(4x+7)^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\left[ -\sin(x^2-1) \frac{d}{dx}(x^2-1) \right] (4x+7) - [\cos(x^2-1)](4)}{(4x+7)^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{[-\sin(x^2-1)](2x)(4x+7) - 4\cos(x^2-1)}{(4x+7)^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{-(8x^2+14x)\sin(x^2-1) + 4\cos(x^2-1)}{(4x+7)^2}$$



$$\textcircled{14} \ y = \frac{5x^3 - 2x}{(x-4)^4}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\left[ \frac{d}{dx}(5x^3 - 2x) \right] (x-4)^4 - (5x^3 - 2x) \frac{d}{dx}((x-4)^4)}{[(x-4)^4]^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{(15x^2 - 2)(x-4)^4 - (5x^3 - 2x) 4(x-4)^{4-1} \frac{d}{dx}(x-4)}{(x-4)^8}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{(15x^2 - 2)(x-4)^4 - 4(5x^3 - 2x)(x-4)^3 (1)}{(x-4)^8}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{(x-4)^3 [(15x^2 - 2)(x-4) - 4(5x^3 - 2x)]}{(x-4)^3 (x-4)^5}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{(15x^2 - 2)(x-4) - 20x^3 + 8x}{(x-4)^5}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{15x^3 - 60x^2 - 2x + 8 - 20x^3 + 8x}{(x-4)^5}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \boxed{\frac{-5x^3 - 60x^2 + 6x + 8}{(x-4)^5}}$$

Find  $y'$ .

$$\textcircled{15} \ y = \frac{4}{(x^3 - 4)^5}$$

$$y' = \frac{\left[ \frac{d}{dx}(4) \right] (x^3 - 4)^5 - 4 \frac{d}{dx}((x^3 - 4)^5)}{[(x^3 - 4)^5]^2}$$

$$y' = \frac{0(x^3 - 4)^5 - 4[5(x^3 - 4)^{5-1} \frac{d}{dx}(x^3 - 4)]}{(x^3 - 4)^{10}}$$

$$y' = \frac{0 - 20(x^3 - 4)^4 (3x^2)}{(x^3 - 4)^{10}}$$

$$y' = \frac{-60x^2(x^3 - 4)^4}{(x^3 - 4)^4 (x^3 - 4)^6}$$

$$y' = \boxed{-\frac{60x^2}{(x^3 - 4)^6}}$$



• ⑩  $y = -\frac{2}{\sqrt{6x-1}}$

$$y = \frac{-2}{\sqrt{6x-1}}$$

$$y' = \frac{\left[\frac{d}{dx}(-2)\right]\sqrt{6x-1} - (-2)\frac{d}{dx}(\sqrt{6x-1})}{(\sqrt{6x-1})^2}$$

$$y' = \frac{(0)\sqrt{6x-1} + 2\frac{d}{dx}((6x-1)^{\frac{1}{2}})}{6x-1}$$

$$y' = \frac{0 + 2\left(\frac{1}{2}(6x-1)^{\frac{1}{2}-1}\right)\frac{d}{dx}(6x-1)}{6x-1}$$

$$y' = \frac{(6x-1)^{-\frac{1}{2}}(6)}{(6x-1)^1}$$

$$y' = 6(6x-1)^{-\frac{1}{2}-1}$$

$$y' = 6(6x-1)^{-\frac{3}{2}}$$

$$y' = \boxed{\frac{6}{\sqrt{(6x-1)^3}}}$$

• ⑪  $y = \frac{-1}{\csc^2 x + 10}$

$$y' = \frac{\left[\frac{d}{dx}(-1)\right](\csc^2 x + 10) - (-1)\frac{d}{dx}(\csc^2 x + 10)}{(\csc^2 x + 10)^2}$$

$$y' = \frac{(0)(\csc^2 x + 10) + (1)\frac{d}{dx}[(\csc x)^2 + 10]}{(\csc^2 x + 10)^2}$$

$$y' = \frac{0 + 2(\csc x)^{2-1}\frac{d}{dx}(\csc x)}{(\csc^2 x + 10)^2}$$

$$y' = \frac{2(\csc x)^1(-\csc x \cot x)}{(\csc^2 x + 10)^2}$$

$$y' = \boxed{-\frac{2\csc^2 x \cot x}{(\csc^2 x + 10)^2}}$$



• ⑮  $y = \frac{8}{4 - \sec^3 x}$

$$y' = \frac{\left[ \frac{d}{dx}(8) \right] (4 - \sec^3 x) - 8 \frac{d}{dx}(4 - \sec^3 x)}{(4 - \sec^3 x)^2}$$

$$y' = \frac{0 (4 - \sec^3 x) - 8 \frac{d}{dx}(4 - (\sec x)^3)}{(4 - \sec^3 x)^2}$$

$$y' = \frac{0 - 8 (0 - 3(\sec x)^{3-1} \frac{d}{dx}(\sec x))}{(4 - \sec^3 x)^2}$$

$$y' = \frac{-8 (-3(\sec x)^2 \sec x \tan x)}{(4 - \sec^3 x)^2}$$

$$y' = \boxed{\frac{24 \sec^3 x \tan x}{(4 - \sec^3 x)^2}}$$



Blank





## Using the Chain Rule Twice

★ Differentiate.

• (19)  $y = \frac{(3-7x)^2}{(x^2+4)^3}$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\left[ \frac{d}{dx}((3-7x)^2) \right] (x^2+4)^3 - (3-7x)^2 \frac{d}{dx}[(x^2+4)^3]}{[(x^2+4)^3]^2}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\left[ 2(3-7x)^{2-1} \frac{d}{dx}(3-7x) \right] (x^2+4)^3 - (3-7x)^2 \left[ 3(x^2+4)^{3-1} \frac{d}{dx}(x^2+4) \right]}{(x^2+4)^6}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{2(3-7x)^1 (-7) (x^2+4)^3 - 3(3-7x)^2 (x^2+4)^2 (2x)}{(x^2+4)^6}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{-14(3-7x)(x^2+4)^3 - 6x(3-7x)^2(x^2+4)^2}{(x^2+4)^6}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{(x^2+4)^2 [-14(3-7x)(x^2+4) - 6x(3-7x)^2]}{(x^2+4)^2 (x^2+4)^4}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{(x^2+4)^2 [-14(3-7x)(x^2+4) - 6x(3-7x)^2]}{(x^2+4)^2 (x^2+4)^4}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \boxed{\frac{-14(3-7x)(x^2+4) - 6x(3-7x)^2}{(x^2+4)^4}}$$



• ②②  $y = \frac{(3x^3+2)^4}{(6x-1)^5}$

$$y' = \frac{\left[ \frac{d}{dx} (3x^3+2)^4 \right] (6x-1)^5 - (3x^3+2)^4 \frac{d}{dx} [(6x-1)^5]}{[(6x-1)^5]^2}$$

$$y' = \frac{\left[ 4(3x^3+2)^{4-1} \cdot \frac{d}{dx} (3x^3+2) \right] (6x-1)^5 - (3x^3+2)^4 \cdot 5(6x-1)^{5-1} \cdot \frac{d}{dx} (6x-1)}{(6x-1)^{10}}$$

$$y' = \frac{4(3x^3+2)^3 (9x^2) (6x-1)^5 - 5(3x^3+2)^4 (6x-1)^4 (6)}{(6x-1)^{10}}$$

$$y' = \frac{36x^2(3x^3+2)^3(6x-1)^5 - 30(3x^3+2)^4(6x-1)^4}{(6x-1)^{10}}$$

$$y' = \frac{(6x-1)^4 [36x^2(3x^3+2)^3(6x-1) - 30(3x^3+2)^4]}{(6x-1)^4(6x-1)^6}$$

$$y' = \frac{(6x-1)^4 [36x^2(3x^3+2)^3(6x-1) - 30(3x^3+2)^4]}{(6x-1)^4(6x-1)^6}$$

$$y' = \frac{(216x^3 - 36x^2)(3x^3+2)^3 - 30(3x^3+2)^4}{(6x-1)^6}$$